Introducing JotBird — instantly publish Markdown as a shareable web page. ✨ ×

Markdown Cheat Sheet

A quick reference to the Markdown syntax.

Overview

This Markdown cheat sheet provides a quick overview of all the Markdown syntax elements. It can't cover every edge case, so if you need more information about any of these elements, refer to the reference guides for basic syntax and extended syntax.

Basic Syntax

These are the elements outlined in John Gruber's original design document. All Markdown applications support these elements.

Element	Markdown Syntax

Heading	`# H1`
	`## H2`
	`### H3`

Bold	`**bold text**`
Italic	`*italicized text*`
Blockquote	`> blockquote`

Ordered List	`1. First item`
	`2. Second item`
	`3. Third item`

Unordered List	`- First item`
	`- Second item`
	`- Third item`

Code	`` `code` ``
Horizontal Rule	`---`
Link	`[title](https://www.example.com)`
Image	`![alt text](image.jpg)`

Extended Syntax

These elements extend the basic syntax by adding additional features. Not all Markdown applications support these elements.

Element	Markdown Syntax

Table	`| Syntax | Description |`
	`| ---------- | ---------- |`
	`| Header | Title |`
	`| Paragraph | Text |`

Element	Markdown Syntax

Fenced Code Block	```
	{
	  "firstName": "John",
	  "lastName": "Smith",
	  "age": 25
	}
	``

Footnote	`Here's a sentence with a footnote. [^1]`
	
	`[^1]: This is the footnote.`

Heading ID	`### My Great Heading {#custom-id}`
Definition List	`term` `: definition`
Strikethrough	`~~The world is flat.~~`

Task List	`- [x] Write the press release`
	`- [ ] Update the website`
	`- [ ] Contact the media`

Emoji (see also Copying and Pasting Emoji)	`That is so funny! :joy:`
Highlight	`I need to highlight these ==very important words==.`
Subscript	`H~2~O`
Superscript	`X^2^`

Downloads

You can download this cheat sheet as a Markdown file for use in your Markdown application.

Take your Markdown skills to the next level.

Learn Markdown in 60 pages. Designed for both novices and experts, *The Markdown Guide* book is a comprehensive reference that has everything you need to get started and master Markdown syntax.

Get the Book

Want to learn more Markdown?

Don't stop now! 🚀 Star the GitHub repository and then enter your email address below to receive new Markdown tutorials via email. No spam!

Your email address

Stay updated

© 2026. A Matt Cone project. CC BY-SA 4.0. Made with 🌶️ in New Mexico.